

Calm confidence, not carnival.

The design system and screen direction for Citefi — a local marketing platform that should feel less like software you operate and more like a coach who's genuinely proud of your progress.

For bocsitcourier/citefi **Audience** local business owners & agencies

Companion to the Citefi Build Blueprint (\$17, \$18.4)

01

Design principles

Five commitments that every screen answers to. They come from one fact about the user: they run a business and use Citefi *at work, to make money* — so the design earns trust by conveying competence and progress, never by manufacturing engagement.

01

Calm confidence, not carnival

Emotional design for professional software means reducing anxiety and conveying competence. Generous whitespace, clear hierarchy, one accent reserved for wins. Warmth through polish, not loud gamification.

02

Progress made visible

The strongest true motivator is seeing real progress on meaningful work. The emotional state on every screen open should be "I'm making progress, and I know my next move."

03

Personal & human

Their business name, their wins, their journey — front and centre. "Good morning, Marcus" beats "Dashboard." The product is in their corner, and the interface says so.

04

The human directs; the AI does

As agents do more, the human's role shifts from operator to director. The primary surface becomes review-and-approve. Every AI action shows its *why*. Autonomy is a dial the user controls, never a default.

05

Words are design material

Copy carries most of the emotion and all of the wayfinding. Warm, plain, specific, active voice. An action keeps its name through the whole flow — "Publish" produces "Published."

02

Colour

A deliberately un-SaaS palette: deep pine-ink on warm paper, sage-tinted neutrals for calm, and a single warm-gold accent reserved *only* for genuine wins — so gold literally means "you achieved something." Spend boldness in one place.

Pine Ink

#1C2B2D

Primary text, primary buttons

Soft Ink

#4A5C5B

Secondary text

Warm Paper

#F6F4EE

App background

Card

#FFFDF9

Surfaces

Sage Deep

#5B7F6F

Sage

#DFE7E0

Win Gold

#C98A2B

Clay

#B8604F

Positive / progress

Progress tracks, calm fills

Wins ONLY — the one
accent

Gentle attention — never
alarm-red

Discipline rule: gold appears on a screen only when something was genuinely earned. If everything is gold, nothing is. Attention/warnings use Clay, which is softer than red — Citefi corrects, it doesn't scold.

03

Typography

Fraunces (a warm, high-contrast serif) for display and moments that should feel human and crafted; Inter for body and UI; JetBrains Mono for data, metrics, and code. The serif is what keeps Citefi from reading like generic dashboard software.

Display / H1

Good morning, Marcus.

Fraunces 600 · 34px

Section / H2

Your marketing journey

Fraunces 600 · 24px

Metric

\$2,400

Fraunces 500 · 26px

Body

Your emergency plumbing page just cracked page 1 in 90026.

Inter 400 · 15px

Label / eyebrow

TODAY'S FOCUS

Inter 600 · 11px · +9% tracking

Data / code

CTR 4.1% · CAC \$45

JetBrains Mono · 13px

04

Core components

The building blocks, all derived from the tokens above. Buttons keep their verb through the flow; badges encode state; the gold badge is a win, clay is attention, sage is healthy.

Review & approve

See the win

Not now

▲ Healthy

🏆 Page 1

Needs reconnect

🎯 TODAY'S FOCUS

Information architecture

Organised around the business's goals, not a menu of tools. The Daily Brief is the front door; Campaigns is where work lives; everything else supports those two.

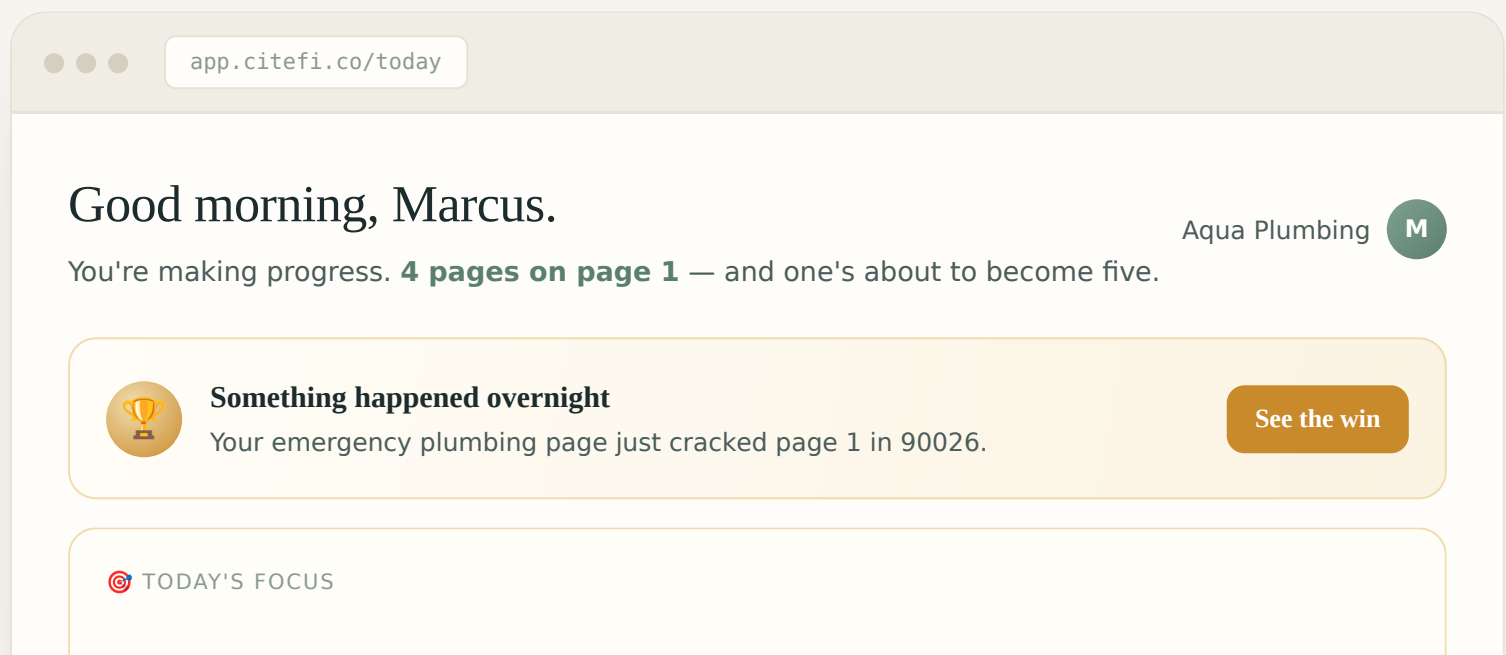
Citefi

- |
- └ **Today** ← the Daily Brief; the default landing screen
- └ **Campaigns** ← goal-based work: content + ads + GEO, on a calendar
 - | └ Content calendar
 - | └ Ads (Google · Meta · TikTok · Instagram)
 - | └ Review & approve feed
- └ **Brand** ← the BrandProfile: voice, service area, personas, assets
- └ **Performance** ← Scorecard (CAC · CLV · ROAS · CTR) + GEO citation tracking
- └ **Clients** ← agency only: workspaces, white-label, re-billing
- └ **Settings** ← channels/connections, team & roles, autonomy level, billing

Key screens

The screens a designer builds first. Each leads with progress and the one next action, keeps chrome quiet, and reserves gold for the win.

- **Today — the Daily Brief** the emotional front door; opens on login



Publish the FAQ that pushes “24-hr emergency plumbing” to page 1.

Climbing three weeks. This is the nudge that finishes it.

Review & approve · 2 credits

YOUR MARKETING JOURNEY

2 service pages from covering every job in your top 3 ZIPs.

✓ Apr · 0

✓ Jul · 4 on pg 1

Full coverage

YOUR NUMBERS — the ones that decide things

COST TO WIN

\$45

▲ healthy

WORTH EACH

\$2,400

53× your cost

AI CITATIONS

6

▲ +2 this month



Worth knowing today: it costs ~\$45 to win a customer worth ~\$2,400 over time. That's a strong ratio — this is the month to spend on ads with confidence, not trim. You've earned the room to grow.

- **Review & approve — the agentic surface** where the human directs and the AI does

app.citefi.co/campaigns/emergency-plumbing/review

Ready for your review

4 ITEMS · AGENTS WORKED OVERNIGHT

Your agents drafted these toward **“own emergency plumbing in your top 3 ZIPs.”** Nothing publishes until you approve.



Content Agent drafted

2h ago

FAQ article: “What to do while you wait for an emergency plumber”

Because your 90026 page is #11 and this supporting content should push it to page 1.

Approve & publish

Edit

Preview



Ads Agent drafted

2h ago

3 Google RSA variants + 2 Meta ads for “Silver Lake emergency plumber”

Your current Meta ad hit frequency 3.4 and is fatiguing — fresh creative ready.

Approve & publish

Edit copy



GEO Agent found a gap

3h ago

You're not cited when people ask ChatGPT “best emergency plumber in Silver Lake”

Drain Masters is. A structured Q&A page on emergency response would likely fix it.

Draft the fix

Later

- **Campaign calendar** where scheduled work lives — drag, approve, publish



app.citefi.co/campaigns

July · Emergency plumbing push

On track

+ New campaign

MON

TUE

WED

THU

FRI

SAT

SUN

14

Article

15

Social x2

16

17

Google ad

18

GEO fix

19

20

21

Article

Social

22

Video

23

Meta ad

24

25

Social x2

26

27

Content Ads GEO Video

- **Connect wizard** step 2 of 3

Approving on Google's screen...

This is Google's own secure page. Log in and approve — Citefi never sees your password, and can't spend a cent without you creating a campaign here first.

▶ 45-sec walkthrough of the exact screen you'll see

Waiting for you to approve in the Google window...

- **Mobile — Today** one-handed, on a job site

Morning, Marcus.

4 on page 1. One's about to be five.

 TODAY'S FOCUS

Publish the FAQ that pushes you to page 1.

Review & approve

 OVERNIGHT

You cracked **page 1** in 90026.

07

Voice & microcopy

The writing carries most of the emotion. Warm, plain, specific, and always true to the user's own data. The rule that separates Citefi from every other dashboard: information about their competence, never a controlling nudge.

MOMENT	INSTEAD OF (CONTROLLING / GENERIC)	WRITE (INFORMATIONAL / WARM)
A win happens	× 🎉 +50 points! Keep your streak alive!	✓ You hit page 1. Three months ago you had zero local rankings.
Bringing them back	× You haven't logged in for 3 days 😞	✓ Your emergency plumbing page just hit page 1 — come see.
A metric	× CAC: \$45	✓ It costs ~\$45 to win a customer worth ~\$2,400. Strong ratio.
A slow week	× Your rankings dropped this week.	✓ A quieter week — marketing compounds. Your 90-day trend is still up.
Connection expired	× Error: token invalid.	✓ Your Meta connection expired — reconnect takes about 20 seconds.
Empty state	× No campaigns found.	✓ No campaigns yet. Pick a goal and Citefi will plan the first one.

Motion, responsive & accessibility

The non-negotiable quality floor. Motion serves meaning; the product is fully usable one-handed on a phone; and it meets WCAG because local owners span every age and ability.

M

Motion with meaning

Animation celebrates and guides, never decorates. The win celebration is the one bold moment — in and out in ~2s. Everything else is quick and quiet.
prefers-reduced-motion
fully respected.

R

Mobile-first

Local owners are on phones, often on a job site. Every core flow — the Brief, approve, connect — works one-handed. The Brief's "one thing" is a thumb-reachable button.

A

Accessible by default

WCAG AA contrast (the palette is built for it), visible keyboard focus, semantic structure, real labels. Accessibility is a floor, not a feature.

Designing for the agentic era

As Citefi shifts from tool to autonomous system (Blueprint §18), the interface evolves with it — but the principles hold. These are the forward commitments.

The feed becomes the centre

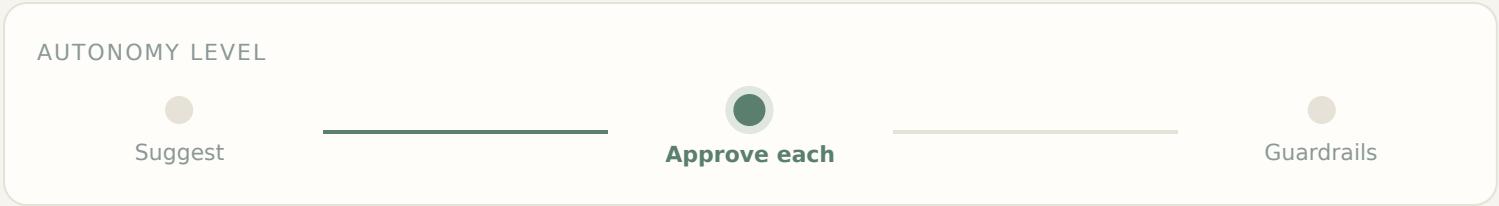
As agents do more work, the review-and-approve feed moves from a sub-screen to the product's heart. The human reads what the agents did, what they propose, and approves or refines in one tap. The role is **director, not operator**.

Explainability is mandatory

Every agent action carries its **why**, in plain language tied to real data ("because 90026 is #11 and climbing"). Trust in autonomy is earned only through transparency — and it's the same informational-not-controlling principle applied to the machine.

Autonomy is a dial

A single setting the user controls: **Suggest only → Approve each → Run with guardrails.**
Trust is granted gradually, never assumed. Autonomy is opt-in, and reversible.



Outcome-first, not feature-first

The interface orients around goals and progress — the Brief, the Scorecard, the journey — not a menu of tools. Software that learns how people work, not the reverse.

Citefi UX/UI Design Document · companion to the Citefi Build Blueprint (\$17 Emotional Design, \$18.4 UI/UX evolution).

Every screen here is a direction to build toward, grounded in the established palette and principles — not final production design.